JavaScript RegExp Meta Characters

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Regular Expression Metacharacters

Metacharacters are characters with special meanings in regular expressions:

Metacharacter	Description
`\d`	Find a digit (0-9)
`\D`	Find a non-digit
`\w`	Find a word character (letter, digit, underscore)
`\W`	Find a non-word character
`\s`	Find a whitespace character
`\S`	Find a non-whitespace character
`\xhh`	Find a character by hexadecimal value
`\uhhhh`	Find a Unicode character

RegExp \d (digits) Metacharacter

`\d` matches any digit character (0-9):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Meta Characters</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>RegExp \d (digits) Metacharacter</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const text = "Phone: 123-456-7890";
const matches = text.match(/\d/g);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Text: " + text + "<br><br>" +
  "match(/\\d/g): " + matches + "<br>" +
  "Finds all digits (0-9)";
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 1

Result View Example

RegExp \D Metacharacter

`\D` matches any character that is NOT a digit:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Meta Characters</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>RegExp \D Metacharacter</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const text = "Phone: 123-456";
const matches = text.match(/\D/g);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Text: " + text + "<br><br>" +
  "match(/\\D/g): " + matches.join("") + "<br>" +
  "Finds all non-digit characters";
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 2

Result View Example

RegExp \w (word) Metacharacter

`\w` matches any word character (letters, digits, and underscore). `\W` is the opposite:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Meta Characters</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>RegExp \w (word) Metacharacter</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const text = "Hello_world 123!";
const words = text.match(/\w+/g);
const nonWords = text.match(/\W/g);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Text: " + text + "<br><br>" +
  "match(/\\w+/g): " + words + "<br>" +
  "match(/\\W/g): " + nonWords;
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 3

Result View Example

The \s (space) Metacharacter

`\s` matches any whitespace character (spaces, tabs, newlines):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Meta Characters</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>The \s (space) Metacharacter</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const text = "Hello World!";
const spaces = text.match(/\s/g);
const noSpaces = text.match(/\S/g);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Text: " + text + "<br><br>" +
  "match(/\\s/g): " + spaces + " (" + spaces.length + " spaces)<br>" +
  "match(/\\S/g): " + noSpaces.join("");
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 4

Result View Example

Document

Document in project

You can Download PDF file.

Reference

- W3Schools JavaScript RegExp Meta Characters